COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Co-Founder at Duvo Believes Domain Expertise and Partnerships Key to Competing in Enterprise Automation

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15 Jul 2026	16 Apr 2026	Consultant	Investor-Led (Buy-Side)	ANTHROPIC

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The conversation covered the design, product approach, pricing, competitive landscape, and go-to-market strategies for an enterprise process automation platform focused on large companies in retail, FMCG, and logistics. The discussion also addressed defensibility against larger AI platforms and the importance of domain expertise and partnerships.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Co-founder with deep experience in enterprise process automation, particularly in FMCG, retail, and logistics, focusing on building scalable automation platforms for large enterprises.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- Believes that domain expertise and the ability to map and automate complex enterprise processes are key differentiators and defensibility against larger, generic automation platforms.
- Sees **significant value in combining consultancy, change management, and automation, and expects partnerships with established industry players to be a strong go-to-market motion**.

TAKEAWAYS

- The platform is designed to enable business users to build and scale automations independently, with IT oversight, focusing on processes with complex handoffs between closed systems.
- The product uses a single-agent, file-based approach leveraging Anthropic's technology, with features for process mapping, automation, and a user-friendly interface for business users.
- Pricing is primarily outcome-based or value-based, targeting large enterprises (over $1 billion in revenue) with typical annual contracts above $75,000.
- The competitive landscape in Europe is fragmented, with legacy players like ServiceNow and UiPath seen as expensive and less scalable, and few specialized competitors in retail and FMCG.
- Go-to-market strategies include both direct sales and partnerships with consulting firms, with partnerships expected to become increasingly important for accessing enterprise clients.

AlphaSense Assistant is AI Generated

Table of Contents

Introduction to Duvo and Market Focus

Client Engagement and Support Strategy

Product Approach and Features

Pricing Strategy and Customer Profile

Competitive Landscape and Key Players

Defensibility and Market Position

Go-To-Market Strategies and Partnerships

Expert Bio

Co-founder at Duvo The expert can speak to the types of customers they work with at Duvo, as well as the most important aspects to customers when procuring Duvo Co-founder at Duvo, responsible for client-side operations and end-to-end project implementation, working closely with customers to transform business processes and deliver automation solutions that improve efficiency and scalability across organisations.

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Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Hello. Thanks so much for taking the time. We're doing some research into the general enterprise process automation or agentic process automation space. We just were curious to pick your brain on a couple questions. Maybe before that, could you tell us a bit about Duvo, your industry focus, who your ICP is, how you would frame Duvo in this massive market that you can cut in so many ways?

Expert 00:00:25

Duvo is automation platform focusing on enabling business people to build and scale the automations, while getting a good sleep for IT to oversee what's going on, who has access to what, and how things operate on scale. We combine the visibility with easiness of use because the vision how Duvo was built is you cannot automate on scale a company through IT department and through IT systems, because you are creating a bottleneck on both exchanging information between business and IT, and also the capacity of IT teams.

The way how we are trying to build Duvo is you operate it very similar to tools such as Claude or maybe Lovable for automation. We focus on enterprise processes from day one. Meaning, we focus on processes where you have a lot of handoffs between closed systems which doesn't have direct connections.

I would say competitive advantage is we are able to use various tools from browsing, operating as a human would do on behalf of human on systems like SAP and these very difficult systems in the companies through direct access, using a voice to call people, and so on. Everything combined together to personalize it to enterprise operations from day one. We focus a lot on FMCG, retail, logistic operations because **we have a strong knowledge and experience to then build tools that helps people in these industries to be more efficient**.

Client 00:01:51

Got you. How come you start in retail, and of course you have your experience. In a longer period of time, will you remain in retail or is it more just that's a great starting point and then we go elsewhere?

Expert 00:02:05

We are building the platform in a way it's universal. We have in mind the vision of being a horizontal platform for any enterprise. From the focus perspective and being able to stand out from the noise, we decided to first start in industries where we have a lot of experience and then expand. Duvo has various type of clients. Some of them are using our services to help them to automate certain processes, but some of them are taking the service as a self-serve. They actually very easily learn how to use the platform and then they distribute it to the company, to the champions, and then we guide them how to approach a certain problems and how to automate certain programs.

Client 00:02:50

Can you touch a bit on that? How forward-deployed are you? Do people just pick up Duvo and they figure it out?

Expert 00:02:58

I would say **it really depends on how messy the stack is**. From my experience sitting with clients, you can teach a person who doesn't know anything about tech to operate Duvo and be able to do quite complex automations within a couple weeks.

Client 00:03:14

Got you. Do you run a forward-deployed motion where you have a solutions engineer who's dedicated for each customer?

Expert 00:03:21

We are not calling them forward-deployed engineer because they are more like AI solution consultants. Their role is not only to build the automation if it's needed, but also to guide and navigate the company, to optimize the process or map the process. We have this kind of motion, but eventually usually the company wants to operate it on their own. Usually, we help them to build a couple processes and they involve their people to observe and then they eventually start building their own, we consult, and they switch to autonomous operation.

Client 00:03:57

Got you. You mentioned your product a bit but can you tell us a bit about your product approach, both from a user perspective but also how you built it?

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Expert 00:04:06

We iterated to use Anthropic system. We have a partnership with Anthropic, and we use something which is called single-agent loop file-based approach. Meaning, you have an agent and the agent is storing knowledge, skills, observations to files, and picking them once they need it. This is an approach which we have found very early on, even before people started using agents like Claude to solve business problems. This is very effective for process automation, and we went this way. **The agent is actually very good at handling context** and be able to solve multiple complex tasks.

From the perspective of user, we do prompt and voice to automation. We have assignment builder where you can tell what you need to build, and we translate it to very, I would say, transparent instructions for both business and agents to be able to understand and make some automation on behalf of that, and then we build a simple structure around these assignments to be able to operate more complex processes. This is like the first piece.

We have very friendly business user interface where people can understand what agent does and what were the steps the agent did, what **it did wrong**, and so on. We can combine them together through some, we call it, case SKUs, which is basically some unit of work or process handled. You can also see which agents were working on the assignments, and so on. We built another feature which is sitting before you even start automate, which is called Clarity.

Clarity helps us and the company to understand how the process is and what processes you have in the company. By having smart AI interview agent, you can distribute it in the company. The agent is interviewing your employees and is proactively asking questions to follow the process, to map the process. Everything will come together in one standardized map, then you can improve, and then based on it, you can even turn it to automation.

Client 00:06:12

How do you think about pricing? What do you charge customers? What's the typical setup?

Expert 00:06:19

In general, the pricing really vary. What I'm seeing on the market and what people understand, it really varies. I think in general, companies don't like token-based consumption. Companies are trying to avoid that. Usage-based model is something which, I would say, is a history of SaaS and it's not applicable to agentic transformation because you don't want to limit people to use your product in the company. You focus on more like either outcome-based pricing, so you take some problem, you estimate the price, and then you take the cut. You basically focus on some hours agent is running or how many processes you resolved, how many problems you resolved.

Client 00:07:02

At Duvo, how do you think, because some people just go up and say, "Hey, here's a fixed annual fee for whatever," and then some people try to do value-based and capture the work they actually create. I'm just trying to understand roughly what's a typical customer look like for you?

Expert 00:07:19

For us, we are focusing on retail and FMCG, so large enterprises and we are trying to focus on outcome-based model, so value-based model. Trying to estimate the price based on the value and then get some cut from it. It depends on the company. You can negotiate to some fixed fee which covers the captured value of a certain amount of processes or you agree to solve specific processes and then charge for the value capture.

Client 00:07:48

Got you. What's the order of magnitude of the customers you try to go after? How much do they pay per year?

Expert 00:07:56

We're trying to chase customers with more than $1 billion revenue, I would say, and we are trying to charge over $75,000.

Client 00:08:05

Got you. If we then shift to the competitive landscape and you look at the different players out there, who do you see as the big ones in the space in Europe that are the most successful so far, besides yourself?

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Expert 00:08:17
I would say in retail and FMCG, we are not seeing really specialized automations emerging from new competitors. Usually, in enterprises they start with a question whether they can leverage their current stack. There is some discussion about how these hyperscalers like Microsoft or Google can be used to internally automate the work. Usually, **these solutions have a limitation** when you are trying to go outside of their space, if you are trying to automate some cross-application processes.

There are some legacy automation tools like ServiceNow or UiPath. Usually, they can do similar things but they are super-expensive to maintain and scale, so people move away from that. I would say there are more technical solutions in the enterprise. We are seeing some companies experimenting with frameworks like LangChain. The internal tech team is automating processes through developing on LangChain framework.

Client 00:09:19
Do you ever run into Solve AI or Distyl or Lovable or Maisa? Are there any of these competitors out there that you run into?

Expert 00:09:29
No, not really. I think Lovable has a bit different purpose. We use it also in my previous company. It's more like you are building some internal applications to organize work, but it's not really it would solve your problem of manual handoffs and so on. We haven't touched Lovable.

Client 00:09:50
Besides ServiceNow and UiPath, are there no other prominent players doing agentic process automation in Europe? Is that your view?

Expert 00:10:00
We haven't really found in our space anyone significantly close to us. We are sometimes hearing about HappyRobot, which is operating more in logistics space and they do a lot of voice automation. I would say these are the ones from the more innovative companies emerging from the AI era. We have seen a couple of big raises like Wonderful which raised a lot of money to be back-office agents for operations. To be honest, we haven't really competed with them in any tenders.

It's also the maturity of the company in terms of thinking the AI. A lot of companies basically they see the need, they don't know how to approach it. They usually have some experimenting with Copilot or n8n, these no-code platforms. They see that **we are solving real problems in retail** and we already launched something in our design companies, and so on, from the history. They are interested in how the real automation brings the value. It's a lot about the strategy and change management right now in enterprises.

Client 00:11:07
If you then like look forward in your mindset of building Duvo or just building a company in the space, how do you think about building the most valuable company here over time? More specifically, the foundational labs Anthropic, OpenAI, they have partnerships with private equity firms and consulting firms to deploy enterprise process automation as their own business, and over time, you end up competing with an Anthropic or a ChatGPT. How do you think about your defensibility as a product?

Expert 00:11:38
What I'm seeing on the market and how I think that the company **who is focusing on enterprise automation can succeed** is you need to start building moat about a certain domain. That's one strategy. Duvo has also have a partnership with Anthropic. We are also one of the partners.

In general, I think Anthropic is tackling much larger deals and the market is huge. They will be focusing on $100 billion deals and it will take time when **they are coming to messy retail with very unknown processes,** and so on. There is a nice Sequoia article that **future trillion companies will come from solving the problems** as a service through productized automation.

I think maybe the future could be that you become the agency which has very powerful tools to scale and automate the processes and you are taking the business from Big Four and other competitors as well. This could be one way how to capture the value. I think sticking to certain domains and then tackling them one by one and developing a core know-how and core skills which are not generic and you cannot replicate them easily, and then being able to improve the processes over time by having a lot of clients **who are solving the same problem** is a way how you can distinguish between a generic automation platform such as Anthropic.

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Client 00:12:59

Yeah. 100% on the focus part. They're going to go after bigger things and then you can get the industry-specific focus or expertise as well. **The one downside** would be if all these companies that you go to, they start taking control of their own fates and they use Anthropic product-led themselves to do this. Are there parts of your product in and of itself or what actually has to get done on the ground with customers that makes it defensible too? How do you think about that? If Anthropic builds a good product, why do people not just pick it up and use it self-serve?

Expert 00:13:36

I think it's also about how good are you in terms of understanding certain core processes and how good you can translate that to something that actually works. I think one moat is we have a product **which is really efficient in capturing the processes**, mapping the processes, and doing the ontology in the companies. It also brings some recommendation how to transfer the processes.

Before you even start, you need to understand how you operate and what to change. With more and more enterprise companies operating similar processes, you can start building your memory of, "Okay, I as an agent actually in the past solved very similar problem, very similar process. This seems like the similar process, so I can apply some learnings from the historical automation."

The ability to build the memory layer on top of the processes and ability to improve over time in a certain skill is something that is definitely valuable, and we see that companies see this as an added value. When you go to automation itself, there are two parts. One is company is trying to automate something that already exists and then company trying to leverage agentic AI to capture value which is untapped because the team is limited. To be able to do this, you need to be able to develop a very good personalized skills and personalized solutions based on your experience how to deliver the transformative value there.

I think there are two things that stick around. One is harnessing a know-how through the automations we have already done and mapping the processes we have already done. The second one is being able to customize it for the people to be able to operate it. I would say the third one, which is more UI-based and control-based, the companies are seeking for product which were business people who doesn't have any clue how agentic operates are able to adopt it and use it and have some kind of visibility or some kind of operation layer for the teams where agents and teams can collaborate the problems.

Client 00:15:39

Got you. When you think about go-to-market here, how do you think about getting customers here? Are there certain strategies that work better than others?

Expert 00:15:48

We have different motions. One is partnership motion. You have companies such as Big Four, BCG, McKinsey, or some retail-specific companies which are operators in these industries but **they are tools to be more efficient**. They try to develop something internally but eventually they realize they don't have, I would say, resources and talent to build it. This is one very strong path where you combine consultancy and change management with automation.

The second one is, I would say, standard B2B approach where you have sales motion in-house which is approaching the companies and you do inbound and outbound. Because **we have a good brand through Rohlik**, we are well-known in retail. People know what we have built in the past and they perceive Rohlik as an innovative company. We have a lot of inbound leads coming in.

We tried to build some product-led motion, so anyone can try it and build some community around it. I would say this one is something **which could be powerful in the future**, but for now we are trying to focus really on these big deals and basically deliver some replicability in high-leverage core processes in these industries.

Client 00:17:05

Yeah. Of these motions, have **you had more success with one or the other**? Have **you had successful partnerships with Big Four or private equity funds or anything**?

Expert 00:17:15

I would say it's 50/50 in terms of in-house sales motion and partnerships. My personal belief is that **partnerships will be very strong motion** because you already have access to companies, you have the stakeholders prepared. What you are lacking is a product which you could leverage and capture the value. We are seeing a lot of motion from our partners to interact with potential clients, and I think **we will benefit a lot from that**.

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Client 00:17:41

Got you. This was super helpful. Really appreciate you taking the time and best of luck with anything. Bye.

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